

MAKAELA FAUBER

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SUMMARY

Outdoor retail leader and Computer Science student (BA expected December 2026) with 7+ years of store experience, most recently as Store Manager for a Backcountry location. Uses Looker and Excel reporting to find what moves conversion, margin, and store operations. Builds software in Java and Python and has run Agile, user-tested projects, including an accessibility redesign. Seeking to bring a store perspective and technical grounding to the product roadmap that connects Backcountry's stores and digital experience.

SKILLS & TOOLS

Product & Analytics: KPI definition and analysis, usability testing, heuristic evaluation, accessibility auditing (WCAG 2.1), Agile (Scrum, Kanban), user stories, Looker, Excel/Google Sheets

Retail Systems: POS, inventory management, Oracle NetSuite, sell-through and inventory aging reporting

Technical: Python (xarray, NumPy, pandas, SciPy), Java, Scala, JavaScript/Node.js, SQL, JUnit, HTML/CSS, Figma, Git

Leadership: Payroll and labor management, margin and shrink management, cross-functional collaboration, training and development, scheduling

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Store Manager | *Backcountry* — Boulder, CO Jun 2025 – Present

- Manage a store with \$738K revenue (trailing 12 months through May 2026), owning margin, shrink, and payroll hours; grew sales 4%, gross margin dollars 6%, conversion 0.4 points, UPT 2%, AOV 3%, AUR 2% despite a 3% decline in foot traffic; the only store in the fleet to grow gross margin rate (+86 bps) over the period.
- Built Looker dashboards to track negative on-hand inventory and weekly price adjustments across all stores.
- Designed a fleet-wide weekly report that lets store managers track KPIs, events, promotions, and feedback.
- Built NetSuite reports to analyze Endless Aisle ordering and trained other store managers on saved searches; built bike-sales reports that supported another store's case for retail-specific bike ordering.
- Delivered the lowest shrink rate of the fleet (0.10% loss) in 2025 through inventory audits and loss-prevention controls.
- Lead, schedule, and develop a team of 8 associates, using labor, traffic, and sales data to match payroll hours to demand.

Key Holder | *Backcountry* — Boulder, CO Jun 2022 – Jun 2025

- Analyzed product-level sell-through data to guide visual merchandising decisions, adjusting floor sets and displays to highlight top performers and move aging inventory.
- Ran daily store operations, including opening and closing, end-of-night reporting, cash handling, and loss prevention.

Store Supervisor & Visual Lead | *prAna Living* — Boulder, CO Jun 2021 – Oct 2021

- Executed floor sets across a 3,200+ sq ft retail floor, translating planograms and trend data into product presentations.
 - Wrote a company-wide visual merchandising manual to standardize stores and train new team members.
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EDUCATION

Bachelor of Arts — Computer Science | *University of Colorado Boulder* — Boulder, CO Dec 2026

- Coursework: Human-Computer Interaction, Accessible Web Design, Universal Design for Digital Media, Database Systems, Data Structures, Object-Oriented Analysis & Design, Software Development
 - Selected projects: Campus events web app; accessibility audit and redesign of nonprofit website; object-oriented design of Clue boardgame; sea surface temperature trend analysis. See portfolio: makfaub.github.io/portfolio
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CERTIFICATIONS

Certificate in Writing | *University of Colorado Boulder* — Boulder, CO 2025

Google Data Analytics Professional Certificate | *Google/Coursera* Jun 2026